

God's Grace Has No Favorites

The Rich Young Ruler Exposed the Difference Between Loving God and Trusting Wealth

Turn with me to Matthew, please. Matthew the nineteenth chapter. This word is rolling around in me so heavily that I am just going to jump right into it. Hallelujah.

Why don't we start with about the sixteenth verse of Matthew 19? Let us read a couple of chapters. Hallelujah. I will begin with verse 16:

And, behold, one came and said unto him, Good Master, what good thing shall I do, that I may have eternal life?

And he said unto him, Why callest thou me good? there is none good but one, that is, God: but if thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments.

He saith unto him, Which?

Jesus said, Thou shalt do no murder, Thou shalt not commit adultery, Thou shalt not steal, Thou shalt not bear false witness,

Honour thy father and thy mother: and, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.

The young man saith unto him, All these things have I kept from my youth up: what lack I yet?

Jesus said unto him, If thou wilt be perfect, go and sell that thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come and follow me.

But when the young man heard that saying, he went away sorrowful: for he had great possessions.

Then Jesus seized the opportunity to teach His disciples:

Then said Jesus unto his disciples, Verily I say unto you, That a rich man shall hardly enter into the kingdom of heaven.

This is interesting. I noticed when this rich young ruler came to Jesus, the first thing he said was, "Good Master, what good thing must I do to enter in?"

Jesus said, "Do not call Me good. There is one good, the Father. You know the commandments." And He ended with, "Love your neighbor as yourself."

For years and years, and as a matter of fact not until He pulled me into this realm of peace, I did not understand what transpired in the Spirit. But that rich young ruler, like many rich young men and wealthy men, carried a sense of power. It is not that this man did not love God. I can

guarantee you he did, because Jesus loved him.

But what he had done was approach Jesus with flattery: "Good Master." I do not doubt that he had bought his way onto the board of several Pharisees. He approached Jesus with flattery.

Jesus said, "You know the commandments." He ended with, "Love your neighbor as yourself."

The man said, "Look, I have kept these from my youth up."

Jesus said, "If you want to be perfect, go and sell what you have. Give all your riches to the poor. Do not give it to Me, because I cannot be bought. Flattery will get you nowhere. Do not give it to Me. Give it to the poor. Then come and follow Me."

Without telling this man directly, "You have not kept the commandments from your youth up," He said, "If you want to be mature, sell what you have. Do not give it to Me. Give it to the poor. Then come and follow Me."

The man was exceedingly sorrowful, for he was very wealthy, and he went away.

Nevertheless, Jesus seized the opportunity to teach His disciples:

Verily I say unto you, That a rich man shall hardly enter into the kingdom of heaven.

And again I say unto you, It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

When his disciples heard it, they were exceedingly amazed, saying, Who then can be saved?

But Jesus beheld them, and said unto them, With men this is impossible; but with God all things are possible.

He looked on them with love because of their dilemma.

I like how matter-of-fact and final God is. It takes it out of the realm of theology, golden-tongued oratory, and speculation. It does not really matter what we think about it. He said:

With men this is impossible; but with God all things are possible.

I can imagine the dilemma of the disciples when they stood there and watched this whole thing take place. They were not exactly yelling as the rich man walked over the horizon, "Burn, rich man! Burn!" It threw them into a dilemma.

Jesus said, "How hardly will a rich man enter the kingdom of heaven." He went further: "It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than this rich man to enter the kingdom of God."

I would say that is a dilemma.

The Eye of the Needle Points to Jesus Entering Poverty on Our Behalf

I meditated on this and tried to meditate on the perspective of a camel being shoved through the eye of a needle. I went to the Greek and researched the eye of the needle, and found out it was talking about a sewing needle. A sewing needle.

No wonder it threw the disciples into a dilemma. "My God, who can be saved if a rich man cannot enter the kingdom?"

You can think what you want, but Luke was a physician. He was not poor. Peter owned a fishing franchise. He was not poor. Matthew was a tax collector. This threw them into a dilemma.

Since the original Greek insinuated a sewing needle's eye, I thought Peter must have gone out all day long to find a needle made out of whale bone, the biggest eye he could find. Then he went and found a pregnant camel, because he was going to grab that little camel as soon as she gave birth and whip it up to the eye of the needle.

He would have Luke guide the nose, Matthew twist the tail, and they would all shove on it. Peter would work the cadence: "Come on, shove. Shove. Because if you can get this little old camel through the eye of this needle, we can be born again and enter the kingdom of God with our wealth. So Matthew and Luke, just shut up and keep on shoving."

It did not matter how much I preached on it, it was not very anointed.

Then I found out from a historical book on customs that there was an outer gate and an inner gate. The outer gate was for traffic during the day, and the inner gate was a security gate. This security gate was built in the shape of a camel's back. It was either called the eye of the needle because it resembled the eye of a needle, or it was called the camel's hump.

Either way, it was an inner security gate. In order for traffic to come in and out of Jerusalem, they literally had to unladen the camel, take all the bags and packages off his back, then get him on his knees. His hump would just fit the eye of the needle, and they would work the camel through.

That was a security gate.

When Jesus beheld these disciples in their dilemma, He said:

With men this is impossible; but with God all things are possible.

I went on to preach the change of the nature of man, that God can take your nature and change it until wealth does not possess you, but you possess it.

Most of us do not have to worry about that too much because we never even get past the part of possessing much wealth. We joke around and say, "I will not have to worry about money having me, because I do not have any."

There are a lot of people who do not have any money and are happy about it. They are happy to be content, do their work, go home, and be happy. That is fine. There is a place in heaven etched out for them.

But these were His disciples He was instructing on wealth. I am His disciple. You are His disciple. He said, "With men this is impossible, but with God all things are possible." He beheld them in their dilemma.

In that security gate, that Jerusalem security gate, the eye of the needle, where they had to unladen the camel, get him on his knees, and wiggle him through the eye into the city, do you know what that was a type of?

For ye know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that ye through his poverty might be rich.

This is another substitution and identification truth. We understand He was made to be my sin, and I was made the righteousness of God in Christ. We understand that. We understand, "Surely He hath borne my sicknesses and carried my pains," that He substituted Himself in my sicknesses and pains.

In 2 Corinthians 8:9, Paul says:

For ye know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ...

He expected us to understand this grace:

...that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor...

That means He actually stepped into my shoes to take the poverty I had coming. It is a substitution and identification truth.

Do you understand this unmerited, unearnable favor shed on you when He stepped into your shoes for the sole purpose of taking your poverty?

Though He was exceedingly rich, He became poor in your place, that you through His poverty might be rich. When we talk rich, we are talking about rich in every aspect in Christ Jesus. But He wanted you to understand that this verse most emphatically covered the fact that He gave up His wealth.

The eye of the needle represented a passage, a doorway through spiritual death. When He said, "With men this is impossible, but with God all things are possible," He was saying that Jesus Christ Himself, in His splendor, His glory, and everything He was, approached the eye of the needle, spiritual death.

Out of the desert and into Jerusalem, into the holy city, into Zion, He stood in front of that gate long enough to lay down His wealth, to be found in the fashion of a man, to lay aside all of His incredible wealth, and then to enter into spiritual death through the eye of the needle and come out the other side in my place.

Then He turned around, looked at me, and said, "Do you understand what I just did? Do you understand the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ? What is impossible with men is possible with Me, because you were not qualified to bear your own poverty, so I bore it for you. You were not qualified to bear your own sins, so I bore them for you. What was impossible with men is possible with God. I laid down not only My heavenly wealth but My earthly wealth and went through the eye of the needle in your place."

Then He says:

For ye know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that ye through his poverty might be rich.

Do you understand that?

The Hundredfold Promise Belongs to Everyone Who Forsakes All for His Name

Let us take it a little further. This sparked Peter the spokesman to ask a question. He asked the same kind of question I would have asked. Look at verse 27:

Then answered Peter and said unto him, Behold, we have forsaken all, and followed thee; what shall we have therefore?

He asked the question most of us are too humble to ask. "We have forsaken all to follow You. What do we get out of it?"

But since somebody else asked this carnal, depraved question, we will enjoy the answer.

Jesus answered:

Verily I say unto you, That ye which have followed me, in the regeneration when the Son of man shall sit in the throne of his glory, ye also shall sit upon twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.

That is wonderful. Thank You, Jesus. That is absolutely wonderful for the twelve. But how about us Gentiles? How about us?

He addresses us in the next verse:

And every one that hath forsaken houses, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my name's sake, shall receive an hundredfold, and shall inherit everlasting life.

And everyone. And everyone. Does that include you? Does that include me? He is talking to you. He is saying, "Now to the twelve, this. But, Frank, this is what I am saying to you."

He is not like men. He cannot lie. If He said this, then by golly, I am going to believe it. Everyone who has forsaken houses, brethren, sisters, father, mother, wife, children, or lands for My name's sake shall receive a hundredfold and shall inherit everlasting life.

The hundredfold is talking about a hundredfold in this life, and then on top of that, everlasting life. Everyone who has forsaken houses, brethren, father, mother, children, or lands for My name's sake, for the gospel, or because of Me, will receive a hundredfold in this life and then everlasting life.

Now three percent of your men in America create the companies that about thirteen percent manage, and the other eighty-four percent or so pretty much punch a time clock. Somebody tells them what to do on the job; they punch a time clock and go home. About thirteen percent manage those, and about three percent create the jobs the others manage and work.

I would have to say that even in the body of Christ, it would be less than three percent I could ever say qualified for this verse. It would help to know why, would it not?

I can tell you this: the more peace of God you operate in, the more dangerous you are. Anybody who can manage pressure in any realm is going to be a success. This is one of the greatest things I found out about peace. When you can operate in it, it will make you unmanageable by the devil.

I said, "Lord, I would like to know why only three percent."

Only that three percent have that ability. They live on the challenge. I would to God we would learn what the victory is that overcomes the world. He said it is even our faith.

The other eighty-four percent manage the challenge of these other guys, and the thirteen percent manage the eighty-four percent. They do the work of the challenge. They are making the three percent rich. The thirteen percent do not do too bad either.

Amen.

I said, "Jesus, You make statements like this. Any man, any man who forsakes all because of My name's sake will get a hundredfold. Any man. Where have we fallen short?"

Remember our meditational law: never take a verse out of context.

The Vineyard Parable Explains Why the First and Last Receive Equally

Look at verse 30:

But many that are first shall be last; and the last shall be first.

Poor King James. He did not know whether to make that the thirtieth verse of chapter 19 or the first verse of chapter 20.

According to the laws of meditation, run ahead to Matthew 20:16:

So the last shall be first, and the first last: for many be called, but few chosen.

Isn't that incredible? Did He change the subject? No, He did not. There should not even have been a chapter 20. It should have been one long chapter 19. He did not change the subject.

Look at verse 29 again:

And every one that hath forsaken houses, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my name's sake, shall receive an hundredfold, and shall inherit everlasting life.

But many that are first shall be last; and the last shall be first.

Then He continues:

For the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder...

Do you know who the householder is? The Lord Jesus Christ. He hired laborers. The laborers are you and I. The vineyard is the kingdom of God. If Jesus hired us to labor in His vineyard, the subject of wages is going to come up.

He did not change the subject. In fact, He went on to give a certain teaching, a type of parable, to explain to you and me the principles that will cause us to receive this hundredfold.

He said:

For the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which went out early in the morning to hire labourers into his vineyard.

And when he had agreed with the labourers for a penny a day, he sent them into his vineyard.

And he went out about the third hour, and saw others standing idle in the marketplace, And said unto them; Go ye also into the vineyard, and whatsoever is right I will give you. And they went their way.

Again he went out about the sixth and ninth hour, and did likewise.

And about the eleventh hour he went out, and found others standing idle, and saith unto them, Why stand ye here all the day idle?

They say unto him, Because no man hath hired us.

He saith unto them, Go ye also into the vineyard; and whatsoever is right, that shall ye receive.

So when even was come, the lord of the vineyard saith unto his steward, Call the labourers, and give them their hire, beginning from the last unto the first.

And when they came that were hired about the eleventh hour, they received every man a penny.

But when the first came, they supposed that they should have received more; and they likewise received every man a penny.

And when they had received it, they murmured against the goodman of the house,

Saying, These last have wrought but one hour, and thou hast made them equal unto us, which have borne the burden and heat of the day.

These last have worked but one hour, and you have made them equal with us.

Tim McFaul's Miracles Confronted My Hidden Resentment Against Equal Grace

When I first began revivals, it was probably two or three years in - maybe even a year and a half - that I went to Klamath Falls. There was a young Baptist boy there by the name of Tim McFaul who had just received the baptism of the Holy Spirit within the last year. He came out to the service because he heard God did miracles.

I was preaching the service, and I called this woman up. She had a broken foot, and it was painful to her. I got down on my knees, grabbed her foot, and said, "Do you believe God will heal you?"

She said, "Yes, I do."

I prayed for her and twisted her foot up. She screamed, and then she realized it did not hurt.

Nevertheless, Tim McFaul wanted to come up and watch the miracle.

I said, "Come on up, Tim."

He got so close I almost had to shove his head out of the way. He just wanted to get real close and watch. Tim McFaul stood up and said, "I am going to follow you around until I have got what you have got."

I thought, "Sure. In the last two years, I have heard that before."

One man came and said, "I am going to do what you do until I have got what you have got." He came Friday and left Monday. He said God told him to leave. I have never seen anybody so double-minded as God. If we judged some of our lives by what we say, God would be schizophrenic, unable to make His mind up. Not only that, He sends you places just to fail miserably.

"God told me to come. I do not understand Him."

He did not send you. If He sends you, He will help you win.

Tim McFaul wanted to see the miracle. He saw it and said, "I will follow you."

Another man came, not Tim. I took him down to the church and prayed him twelve hours a day and gave him two cups of coffee over the weekend. That was it. No food or anything. I kept him right with me to do what I did. Monday came, and God told him to go home.

One man came who was so super-led. We were out in miracle rallies, and all of a sudden they would show up on your doorstep, thinking you live on some kind of glorious mountain.

"God told me to come."

This guy was so super-led he could not even leave his room unless God told him to leave his room, or what loaf of bread to buy. One day he told my wife, "I do not even wash my clothes unless God tells me to."

My wife's reaction was something like, "I am not God, but you will wash your clothes."

When I went into revivals here and there, old Tim was sitting out there. Finally I asked him, "Do you not work?"

He said he was off for the summer.

Finally the Lord said, "You do something with him. You disciple him."

So I bootlegged about sixty tapes and gave them to him. I said, "I want you to listen to these six times apiece. Then I want you to pray in the Holy Ghost six hours a day for six months. I do not want this mowing-the-lawn-and-praying stuff. I want you locked up and praying. No listening-to-tapes kind of thing. Locked up praying."

Usually you get rid of people when you tell them that. I thought I had gotten rid of Tim McFaul pretty much.

About six months later, I went back to his town. We started the meetings with testimonies. "Who was healed in the last meetings?"

This woman finally stood up. "I had a deaf ear, and it popped open at the moment of prayer."

I was thinking, "Which one of my services did it pop open in?"

She said, "It was not yours at all. It was Tim McFaul's."

I felt like saying, "Just shut up and sit down, lady."

This lady had the audacity to stand up and say, "My brother was in the insane asylum, and I stood in proxy, and he woke up sane the next morning. They had to let him out."

I said, "Which one of my services did this take place in?"

"It was not yours at all. It was Tim McFaul's."

Again this animosity and hate rose up, and I felt like saying, "Shut up and sit down. Was anybody healed in anything I ever did in this town?"

Tim came in sometime in the course of that meeting. I said, "Yo, Tim. Can you hang around?"

Afterward, I believe he was driving me, and we got to talking.

I said, "God is starting to use you, huh, Tim?"

"Yup."

He does not say a lot sometimes.

"He is really using you, right?"

"Yup."

"When did He start using you?"

"Oh, two months ago."

"He is really using you in miracles? That insane asylum?"

"Yup."

"What happened?"

"What do you mean, what happened?"

"I want to know what happened. What did you do?"

"What do you mean, what did I do? I did what you told me."

I said, "Oh yes, it works, doesn't it? Glory to God. If there is anything else you want to know, do not hesitate to ask. I have been in this a while, you know."

But if you want to know how I felt, I sat over there hunched up in the passenger seat, and I was raging inside. I was thinking, "This is not fair. I have borne the burden in the heat of the day. I have been filled with the Holy Ghost for ten years, and he has only been filled for a year and a half. I have worked eleven hours, not one hour, and You paid this rascal the same as You have paid me. Look at the miracles You are doing."

And He says, "Are you mad at Me because I have made you equal? It is not by works. It is by grace. So the last will be first, and the first will be last. It does not matter whether you get in at the third, sixth, ninth, or eleventh hour. It is not based on how many hours you work. It is based on the equality that He has made us through the cross and through the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ."

The Same Grace That Blesses a New Believer Also Belongs to the One Who Taught Him

You say, "Well, you were guilty of that, Brother Roberson."

You are guilty too.

You are walking in faith and testifying to somebody, and you finally get them turned on to the Word.

"You mean God does not want me to live in this poverty shack? He wants me to have new shoes for my kids and clothes for my kids? He does not want me to live in this poverty shack?"

"All you have to do is believe the Lord Jesus Christ. In fact, Mark 11:23 says you can say to the mountain, 'Be removed and cast into the sea.' If you doubt not in your heart, you will have what you say with your mouth. You can speak to the mountain of poverty because Jesus Christ has given you His standing."

"By the way, I have been confessing myself for a new house for six years. I am believing this time I will have a swimming pool with it, a new house with three bedrooms and a two-car garage. I am being specific. I have been confessing for it for six years."

"So come over here, you little flesh creature. I will teach you how to confess. How long have you been born again?"

"About three months."

"Let me disciple you, you little flesh creature. You can have what you say with your mouth because Jesus has borne your poverty. What are you believing?"

"I am believing to come out of this old shack and have food for my kids and clothes and shoes to send them to school. I could sure use another house."

"You just start confessing the Word like I am confessing it, and I will teach you."

You start talking to the poverty:

"Poverty, are you listening to me? I, Dave Roberson, can say to the mountain. Poverty, are you listening to me? You bow your knee to the Lord Jesus Christ. You depart from me. Prosperity, I am calling you in. Raises on the job, I am calling you in. House, I am calling you in, in the name of Jesus."

"And you can have it."

"I can?"

"Yes, you can."

About six months go by, and you lose contact with your little flesh-creature disciple. Soon you get a phone call.

"Hello?"

"Yeah, this is flesh-creature disciple. I just want to thank you so much. My God, I want to thank you. You remember what you taught me about confessing the Word?"

"Oh yes, little flesh creature, I remember. Isn't it glorious?"

"Yes, yes, it is glorious. Guess what? This stuff works. It works. I did not get a three-bedroom house. I got a four-bedroom house. It has a three-car garage, and I got two new cars to put in it. Guess what? I have a swimming pool, and I am the president of a company. They paid me a hundred-thousand-dollar bonus check just to begin with their company. This thing works so good. I am having a housewarming. Can you come over as the guest of honor at my housewarming? You have taught me so much."

You go, "I am busy."

"I was three when I was filled with the Holy Ghost. I was four when I was bearing the burden in the heat of the day. I labored in the vineyard for eleven hours, and You took that little flesh creature and made him equal to me?"

"Because I have made you equal. It is not based on your works. It is based on His grace."

Praying in Tongues Turns Grace From Doctrine Into Experienced Force

Now let me tell you something about praying in tongues. Can I? I might as well; I will do it anyway.

I had no idea the first three, four, or five months of answering my call at the age of thirty what praying in tongues was specifically doing on the inside of me. In my prayer closet, I only knew that the Word of God said it would edify me, that the Word of God said it would build me up on my most holy faith.

Of course, now you and I understand this precious gift to be a revelation gift, one that cultivates your ground, your spirit, to receive mysteries, divine secrets, and revelation knowledge.

When we speak mysteries and divine secrets, we know these are the same ones hidden in Christ Jesus, or hidden in God through Christ Jesus, from the foundations of the world. The mysteries we are speaking are not for God's benefit, because none of us is going to sneak up on His blind side and whisper some divine secret in His ear that He had no knowledge of.

But I can tell you that you cannot pray in tongues an hour without communicating some mystery of some aspect of Christ in you, the hope of glory.

When He answers these mysteries, it is as unique as answering the prayer of confession when you call prosperity into your life day after day, speak to the mountains, and command raises to come in. It is as powerful when God answers that prayer as when He answers the prayer of confession.

The reason is this: we can study about the forces of love and mercy until our studier falls out on the ground. We can study about the force of grace until we think we are great intellectual expounders on the original Greek. But forces like grace, mercy, and love are more experienced than taught.

I can teach you all about what grace will do. I can describe it as accurately as I understand it from the Word. But forces like grace are more to be experienced than analyzed.

When you pray in tongues, the part no teacher can give you will be the analyzation of grace and the activation of it in your spirit as a force.

It was activated upon your confession when you were born again. But grace did not stop there. Grace did not stop there.

For ye know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor...

Do you understand this grace?

I did not. I still had strings of legalism hanging on to me from my ultra-holiness days. I believed for years that God would turn on you as quickly as He had prospered you and take your blessing away to teach you some valuable lesson you were too hard-headed to learn outside of severe testing and trial.

Grace Became Real to Me When Works Died at the Foot of the Cross

I started praying in the Holy Ghost. Boy, we did not have anything. I went full-time, trying to pastor a little church with about twelve people in it, including kids. Nobody really wanted to listen to me preach much because I did not have any experience.

Where do you get it?

The only training I had was seven years of ultra, ultra-holiness preachers standing up screaming at me. The first three or four years I did not learn a lot. In the last few, I learned even less. I joined a church that was more legal than the other church.

When I entered full-time at thirty, I did not know any Word. I did not know anything. I got turned on to the Word, got Hagin tapes, and spent three months praying in the Holy Ghost.

I expounded these mysteries from my spirit up before God, and one day after four or five months or so, He started answering them.

I was trying to use my confession as accurately as Kenneth Hagin taught it on the tapes. I said, "I have a new car. I am calling that car in. I thank You, Father God. I confess it. I receive it, and I believe it past tense. Therefore, I have a new car."

Then I would start talking the other way, and Earl Hitzon, my mentor, would say, "No, it is past tense." We got into the tapes together, and he taught me a lot about the Word.

I will never forget when the revelation of grace, to the degree I understood it that day, came. I prayed that mystery, which is better experienced than taught. I prayed that mystery of grace concerning finances up before my Father.

The morning He answered was around noon. I had spent probably six solid hours. I was sitting there, and a fluctuation into my spirit rose. This understanding of grace permeated my whole being and started getting into my intellect in the form of faith. A know-so came over me.

I said, "My God, I have a new car. I really do. I really do."

Grace continued to flood my soul. My works died at the foot of the cross. Realization hit me that I could not earn, merit, labor hard enough, or labor long enough for one of His blessings. I could not give enough to earn the standing of wealth He gave me by grace. I simply had to accept it by faith.

Now I labor until my fingernails have reached my knuckles, not because I am trying to earn anything, but because I have fallen in love with my Father.

Earl Hitzon came into prayer that morning, and I said, "Earl, I have received my new car."

The day before, I was taking him out and showing him my air tires. You have heard of cords? That is when the cords are showing. Air tires are when the air is showing, and the creative miracle is holding them underneath your car.

I used to buy my tires for four dollars apiece from the junkyard on the rim. When I had a long trip, I would put them in the back seat and the trunk, and if I was driving down the highway and had a blowout, I would just put the whole thing on.

I would get to the meeting and hide my car out behind the hall I preached in, in the tall grass, because I preached prosperity and did not want anybody to see my car. Then I would have to wait for the crowd to leave to get my sleeping bag, roll it out, and sleep under the table in the hall I was

preaching in until the fire marshal caught me and ran me out.

It was okay. There were not very many people there anyway. It was okay, though. I got to preach. I did not care if there were six or seven. I got to preach. I was called to preach.

Many times I would preach my heart out and there would be sixteen dollars in the offering, barely enough to eat on, much less get home. I would walk into the kitchen in fellowship on closing night, and somebody would say, "God bless you, Brother Roberson," and I would get one of those greasy handshakes, you know, when body oil gets on a hundred-dollar bill. You feel that and go...

The first few times it shocked me so badly I would look at it right in front of them. That is not kosher. I would take it and go home.

I remember the first time a woman gave off of her business. Besides that, the offerings that week were three hundred dollars. And besides that, a woman had me stop off by her business and run in and get a check for sixty dollars.

I want you to know, sixteen or seventeen years ago, I came off this little old meeting, and my junky old car had a thousand dollars in it, and I thought I had died and gone to heaven.

When He activated that grace, He took fear. The level of fear I had been walking in died. My works died at the foot of the cross. I started realizing something. From my heart, the love of God began to pour out in worship and worship and worship, and bawling, because I had that car.

"Okay, so you have a car. Where is it?"

I was so convinced.

"Where is it?"

I said, "Oh, it is in here."

Two weeks later, my wife and I drove a brand-new Volkswagen van off the showroom floor in Eugene, Oregon. We wanted the show model. It took them a while to move the cars out of the way, but we wanted the show model. We drove it off the showroom floor, and twenty-five cents had changed hands in the transaction. Twenty-five cents.

Three or four days later, in a meeting, some man anonymously handed me a check. He did not want his name on it. He did not want to be known. I remember inching the zeros back one at a time when I folded the check to Earl Hitzon, until I got to the third and fourth zero. I kept pulling it back until old Earl Hitzon went, "My God."

It was a check for five thousand dollars and paid the Volkswagen van off.

Grace Makes the One-Hour Worker and the Eleven-Hour Worker Equal

I said all that to come here. Listen to me. He gave you His standing by grace, and there is not a thing you can do to earn it.

Through the Word of God, you can enforce that standing of grace He has given to you. It does not matter whether you worked one hour or eleven. He has made you equal.

He has given you Mark 11:23:

Whosoever shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea...

He said you can say. You can talk to it. You can call it in.

I talked to that car every day. I called it in and worshiped God, and spoke mysteries, and talked to the car, and worshiped God, and spoke mysteries, and talked to the car, and worshiped God, and spoke mysteries, until the three came together and produced the car.

Glory to God.